

Backdoor Attacking: The backdoor attack involves establishing a trust relationship through the ‘pairing’ mechanism, but ensuring that it no longer appears in the target’s register of paired devices. In this way, unless you are actually observing your device at the precise moment a connection is established, you are unlikely to notice anything untoward, and the attacker is free to use any allowed resource for trusted devices, such as file transfers. This means that not only can data be retrieved from the phone, but other services, such as modems or Internet, WAP and GPRS gateways may be accessed without the owner’s knowledge or consent.

Bluebug Attacking: The Bluebug attack creates a serial profile connection to the device, thereby giving full access to the AT command set, which can then be exploited using standard off the shelf tools, such as PPP for networking and gnokii for messaging, contact management, diverts and initiating calls. With this facility, it is possible to use the phone to initiate calls to paid numbers, send or read SMS messages, connect to data services such as the Internet, and even monitor conversations in the vicinity of the phone. Monitoring conversations is done via a voice call over the GSM network, so the listening post can be anywhere in the world. Bluetooth access is only required for a few seconds in order to set up the call. Call forwarding diverts can be set up, allowing the owner’s incoming calls to be intercepted, either to provide a channel for calls to more expensive destinations, or for theft by impersonation of the victim.

The way the trend is going, it seems that 2005 will see a big rise in the number of mobile phone viruses. That’s why companies such as SimWorks International Limited have already worked out an antivirus for the Symbian series 60 phones.

SimWorks Anti-Virus protects phones from all known viruses including Cabir a, Cabir b, Cabir c, the Mosquitoes dialer and the Skulls trojan. The antivirus is basically a

